

HVAC

Cold-Calling Talk Tracks



FieldEdge
by xplor

FieldEdge Presents:

HVAC Cold-Calling Talk Tracks



Face-to-face canvassing, door knocking, and five-arounds are among some of the many names, yet the same approach, to HVAC cold-calling.

The idea here is simple: get in front of a potential customer, introduce, endear and win over new business in the span of a conversation.

However, the field team completing the scheduled work isn't necessarily skilled in cold sales. This is why we often load the service trucks with **flyers**, **business cards**, and **door hangers**.

We've compiled a simple talk-track template for your field team to understand the:

- Basic flow of these impromptu conversations
- Potential responses they can provide to customers
- Key takeaways for every step of the conversation

This will help guide conversation, spur conversion, and help your field team feel confident approaching potential customers while out on the job.

Navigating a Face-to-Face HVAC Cold Call



Introduce Yourself

It's important to introduce yourself first. Your team is approaching a neighboring property. No one wants to be disturbed, especially with an awkward conversation initiated by a stranger looking to sell something.

Example: “Hi, I’m Steven with ABC HVAC. Your neighbor, Jeff, called us about a year ago to help with a system tune-up and air filtration due to pollen. Do you also notice a lot of pollen here during the spring?”

Key Takeaway: Keep the conversation going by starting with questions that evoke an easy ‘yes’ response.

Identify the Homeowner/Decision-Maker

Remember, before you start identifying the homeowner/decision-maker, your own personal identification should already be out of the way. The person you're speaking to should know who you are, who you represent, and why you're standing in front of them.

The three necessary bits of information to gather:

- Who they are
- What they do for a living
- What they care about most

Each of these elements of information is integral in building a basis for rapport as well as identifying services that may be a fit for this homeowner. Does this person have sole ownership of the property? Are they even a decision-maker?

For Renters: If the property is being rented, this doesn't mean you can't service this location. It just means the decision-maker is not onsite. Find out what you can about the property manager or owner. This could lead to a follow-up call and a huge win should the property manager take a liking to you and your services.

Examples: "You have a lovely home here, have you been in this neighborhood long?"

"Do you have a preferred HVAC service?"

"When's the last time you've had your system inspected for annual upkeep?"

Key Takeaway: Once the introduction is out of the way, identification of the person you're speaking to becomes crucial.

Reveal Pain Points

You want to be of service. This is where active listening becomes critical. Where are this homeowner's pain points? How can your business address them?

Potential Pain Points:

- **Total HVAC load**
- System maintenance
- Dust/Dander/Pollen (Allergies)
- Cold Spots/Hot Spots in house
- Outdoor Unit Maintenance/Cleaning



Example: “We’ve noticed a lot of homeowners around here struggling this time of year with the amount of pollen from these beautiful cedar trees. Have you replaced your air filters recently?”

Key Takeaway: Listen for key phrases like allergies, drafts, inconsistent temps, A/C that struggles to keep up. Each of these are tickets to solutions you can offer.

Build Rapport

You're there to help, sure, but you also should be friendly about it. People love doing business with those that are kind.

This means building rapport with a stranger, which is scary, but not at all impossible. Part of this process is showing your ability to listen to the needs of someone else, and offer up contextual solutions to those problems. The best listeners are often the best salesmen.



Example: “I hear you about how your kids struggle with seasonal allergies. I’ve got a little one at home that needs to carry an inhaler this time of year because of these trees. They’re beautiful trees but that pollen is a lot! Have you considered using a higher quality air filter to help keep those particulates outside where they belong?”

Key Takeaway: Your deep knowledge and ability to solve problems will be integral as the relationship builds, but first, you have to make a connection.



Service Pitch

The service pitch comes later in the conversation. Why?

This homeowner needs to feel heard and know you understand what their needs are before you come to them with options, ideas, and specific service.

Example: “Honestly, your system sounds like it’s running great! Maybe we could swing back by in a few weeks before the weather turns, just to make sure you’re ready for spring. How does that sound?”

Key Takeaway: Present the options that fit their needs, not some canned speech or one-size-fits-all solution.

Availability

Simple mention of your availability. Focus on when you'll be around the neighborhood unless there's an urgent need presented earlier.



Example: “No need to agree on anything today. We'll be working on your neighbor's system next month. Here's our card if you need anything in the meantime. While we are there we can swing back by to answer any questions or give your system a quick inspection!”

Key Takeaway: By this point, if the homeowner hasn't nibbled on a service, it's up to you to let them know you'll be in the neighborhood frequently and when you plan to follow up. This alludes to the **mere-exposure effect**, and may help connect your brand with reliability and availability.

With FieldEdge, you'll have access to automated reminders to follow up with potential customers on your next visit.

Book your FREE personalized demo today!

Common Objections with Example Responses & Solutions

You'll likely never get through an entire sales conversation without hearing an objection. Here's a handy quick-reference guide on common objections and simple responses that can keep the conversation moving forward.



No Time

Perhaps the most common objection of them all. It's possible this is used as a dismissive wave off of an interaction. Regardless, respect the homeowner's wishes, and remember this is all about relationship building, not a hard sale.

Example Response: "Totally understandable, we'll be in the neighborhood frequently since we are your neighbor's preferred HVAC service. We'll plan to check in next time we are in the area. In the meantime, here's our card if you ever need to contact us for an emergency."

No Money

Always a consideration when discussing service and maintenance. It helps to remind the homeowner that costs do arise, and often catching things early actually saves money.

Example Response: "Yeah, times are tight. Just remember an ounce of prevention is worth a pound of cure. Sometimes problems caught early can be resolved for far less than if they spiral into a full blown emergency! If you notice any minor concerns, here is my card."



No Need

It would be easy to ignore this objection, but it's best to confirm the homeowner's ability to decipher their needs. So, instead of negating their objection, lean into it. Praise their knowledge, and suggest a follow-up visit later on to help keep the system running as they like.

Example Response: "Glad to hear your system is working optimally! If you want to keep it running smoothly all year long, consider our yearly service tuneup. You can read more about it on our website, [insert catch website name here], which you can also find on my card."

No Interest

This objection is often best to let things lay and slip away. If a homeowner shows no interest, or outwardly insists they're not interested. Just thank them for their time and attention and move on.

Example Response: "Sure thing, I won't keep you. Thanks for your time!"

No Rapport

Sometimes, you caught a homeowner at a bad time or on a bad day. Don't take it personally! If the conversation stalls out, or if the homeowner becomes heated, just remind them you service the area and walk away.

Example Response: "Well, we'll be servicing your neighbor's HVAC needs, so if you ever find the need, we won't be far! Here is my business card if anything ever comes up."



No Familiarity in HVAC

Use this as an opportunity to educate the homeowner on the topic you love. Plus, the benefit of them not needing to know about their HVAC system is a good thing! That means things are running as they should.

Example Response: "It's an easy thing to overlook, and it's great to hear everything is working as it should. If any questions arise about your HVAC system, or if you want to schedule a tune-up, don't hesitate to reach out!"

Use the Best Field Service Software to Present Options Onsite

No one likes fumbling with paperwork, and busy homeowners just want to get back to what they were doing. That's why cloud-based **field service software** is becoming such a game changer for onsite multi-option quoting.

Once a customer is interested, empower your team to present multiple options like good, better, best solutions along with visual examples right from their phone or tablet.

The best field service software can assist with onsite price presentations, scheduling and invoicing. You can even accept payments right on the spot!

With FieldEdge your team will be more effective at onsite selling, scheduling and securing payment.

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